GLOBAL MENTORSHIP INITIATIVE

Session 3 – Student Guide

Building Your Business Network with LinkedIn



globalmentorship.org

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GMI's Process for Getting a Great Job

- There are great job opportunities at companies you haven't heard of. Make it easy for these companies to find and recruit you through LinkedIn.

- Focus on LinkedIn now to connect with as many people as you can before you start applying for jobs. You will need some of these people to open doors at the companies you want to work for. Use the GMI templates to make this easy. LinkedIn allows for 5 connections with a message per month.

- If you want people to connect with you, have a strong LinkedIn profile in place before you begin. Skipping this step will sabotage the entire process going forward.

- Don't let other social media accounts harm your job search. For example, make your Facebook and Instagram accounts private.

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GMI's Process for Getting a Great Job

- **Use all the tools available to you:**
  - Templates for connecting with people
  - Templates to get job references on LinkedIn
  - Include the right keywords in your profile
  - Add the right skills to your profile to match the jobs you are applying for
  - Follow companies on LinkedIn you want to work for
  - Use other templates for thank-you notes, recruiter communications, resume/CV templates
  - Develop your own communication templates so you can reach a lot of people quickly and efficiently

Your job right now is to prepare for your lifelong career.

People who are serious about success will allocate at least an hour a day to these activities.

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Why LinkedIn is so Important

50%
of hiring managers will decide to proceed with your application based on your LinkedIn profile.

91%
of marketing executives list LinkedIn as the top place to find quality content.

94%
of recruiters say they use LinkedIn to find candidates.

100 million
members login every day

260 million
members login every month

500 million
LinkedIn members worldwide

LinkedIn is a requirement in today's professional job market.

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Your LinkedIn Profile Should Already Have:

- **All LinkedIn fields completed**
  - Headline & summary
  - Headshot
  - Banner behind your headshot
  - A summary that captures attention
  - Detailed work & volunteer experience
  - Education details

Important: If you haven't finished these steps, complete the training at this link before proceeding:
https://globalmentorship.org/CareerReadinessTips/

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Mentorship Session Goal: Recruiters Seeking You

- Use “keywords” to help recruiters find you
- Add 30 – 50 specific skills to your profile

- How to use your network to find job opportunities
- How and why you should join LinkedIn professional groups
- How to easily get job references on LinkedIn
- How to find jobs on LinkedIn and connect with recruiters

Use the LinkedIn Content and Templates documents. You can copy and paste these templates for your LinkedIn work to save time.

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GMI Student Profile Example



Katy Student

Accounting major ready for financial management opportunities - graduating May 2022

Greater Seattle Area · Contact info

Costco Wholesale

GMI University

Use this LinkedIn profile as a template:

www.linkedin.com/in/gmistudent

This LinkedIn profile gets requests for interviews every week!

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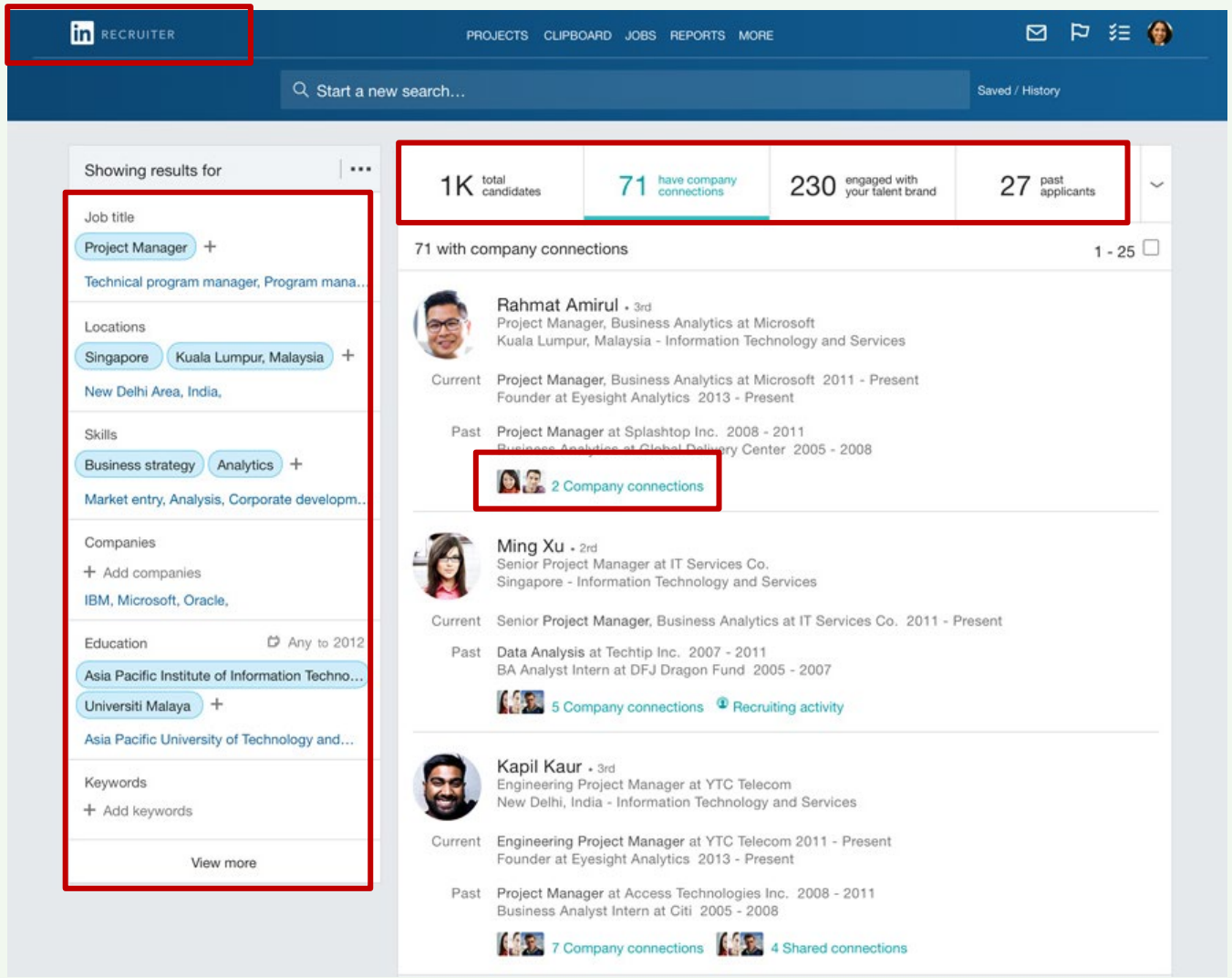
How Job Recruiters Use LinkedIn

Primary Search Priorities

- Job experience
- Location
- Skills
- Education
- Other keywords

Additional Search Priorities:

- Open to new opportunities
- Company connections
- Engaged with your talent brand



LinkedIn Talent Solutions

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Find Keywords in a Job Description

- When recruiters search for candidates on LinkedIn, they focus on keywords in the job description.

✓ Add 10+ keywords in your LinkedIn profile from the job posting you are applying for.

✓ Apply keywords here
  - Headline
  - Experience
  - Summary

✓ In your profile, name the industry you're interested in – it's a keyword.

LinkedIn's algorithm shows recruiters the most relevant profiles based on their keyword search.

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Find Keywords in a Job Description

Accountant Job Description

- Summary
  We're looking for an organized and driven Staff Accountant to join our growing team at our company. The Staff Accountant position will work closely with our other accountants and operations personnel and handle day-to-day bookkeeping.

Responsibilities

- Perform monthly, quarterly and annual accounting activities including reconciliations of bank and credit card accounts, coordination and completion of annual audits, and reviewing financial reports as necessary.
- Analyze and report on financial status including income statement variances, communicating financial results to management, budget preparation and analysis.
- Improve systems and procedures and initiate corrective actions.
- Oversee taxes and abide by federal regulations.

Qualifications

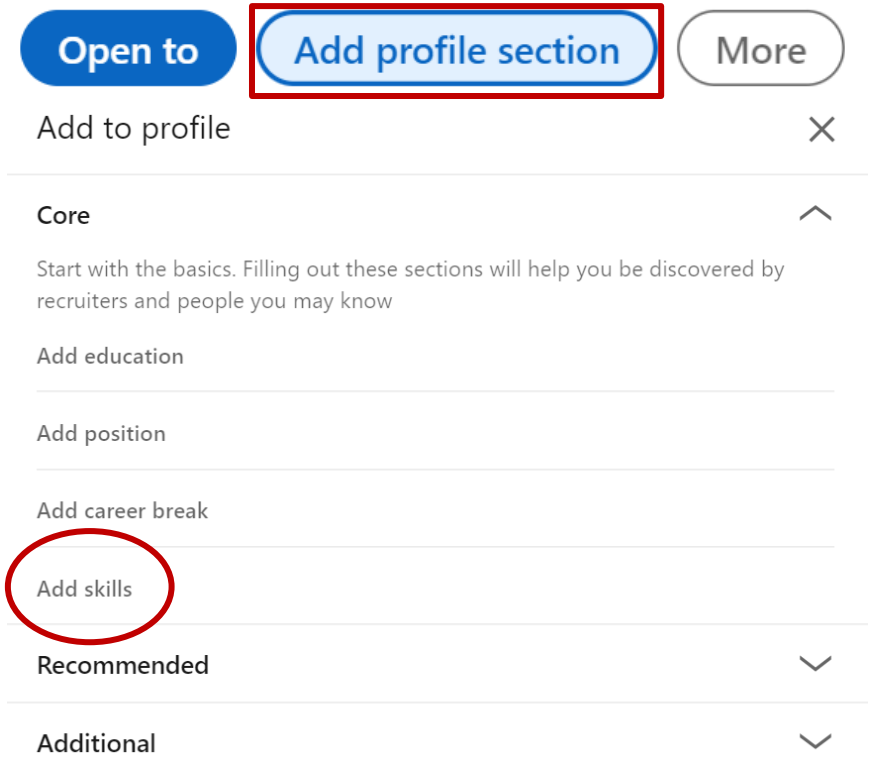
- 2+ years accounting experience
- Expertise with QuickBooks
- Extensive knowledge of US GAAP
- Advanced computer skills in Microsoft Office, accounting software and databases
- Excellent organizational, problem-solving, project management and communication skills
- Additional experience in audit and International accounting
- Experience with SaaS companies

Keywords

- ✓ Accountant
- ✓ Bookkeeping
- ✓ Reconciliations
- ✓ Financial reports
- ✓ Analyze / Analysis / Audit
- ✓ Budget preparation
- ✓ Taxes
- ✓ QuickBooks / Microsoft Office
- ✓ GAAP / SaaS
- ✓ Databases
- ✓ Project Management
- ✓ International Accounting

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Adding Skills to Your Profile



Skills are a primary search criteria for job recruiters

- ✓ Use keywords found on job descriptions
- ✓ Add 30 – 50 skills
- ✓ As you add LinkedIn connections, you will get more endorsements validating your skills with employers

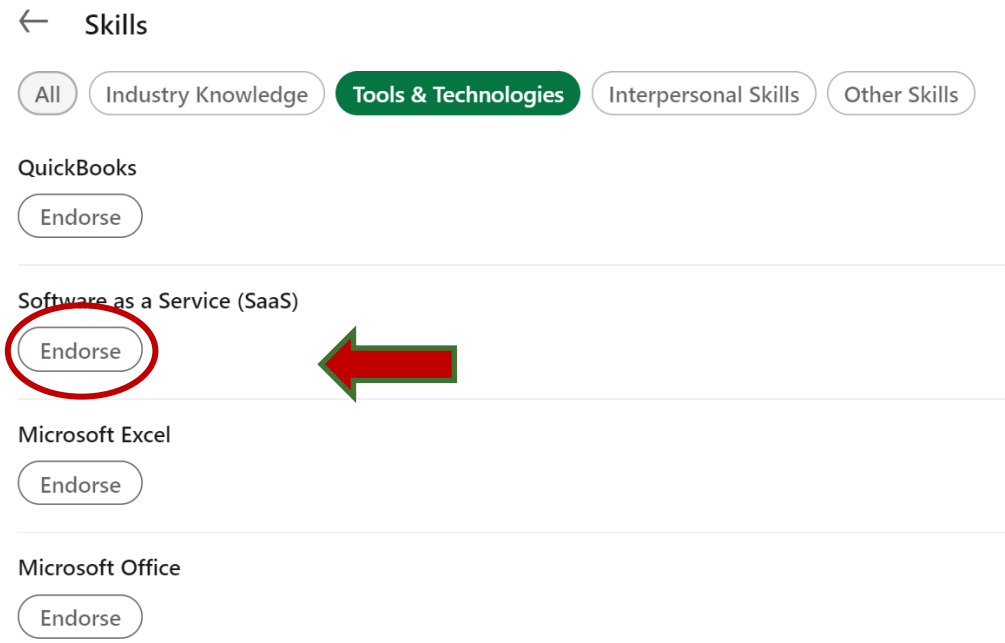
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Getting People to Endorse Your Skills

- ✓ Your connections will endorse you for skills they have observed.
- ✓ You can request endorsements from coworkers, supervisors, teachers, and other professional contacts.
- ✓ **Endorse others to get more endorsements for yourself.**

To endorse someone, go to their profile and scroll down to "Skills".

How to Endorse Someone



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Making Professional Connections

Don't be shy about connecting with people. It is expected and everyone who is successful in business does this.

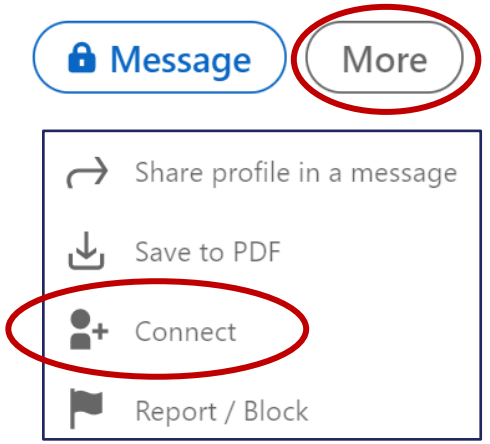
Not everyone will accept your invitation to connect. Don't let that stop you, it's a numbers game and nothing personal.

Use the search bar at the top of your home page to search for connections.

- ✓ Anyone who works at companies where you want to apply
- ✓ Current and past students where you attended college
- ✓ Current and past work colleagues
- ✓ People in professional groups
- ✓ People that have a common interest in a non-work topic



If you don't see a "Connect" button on their profile:



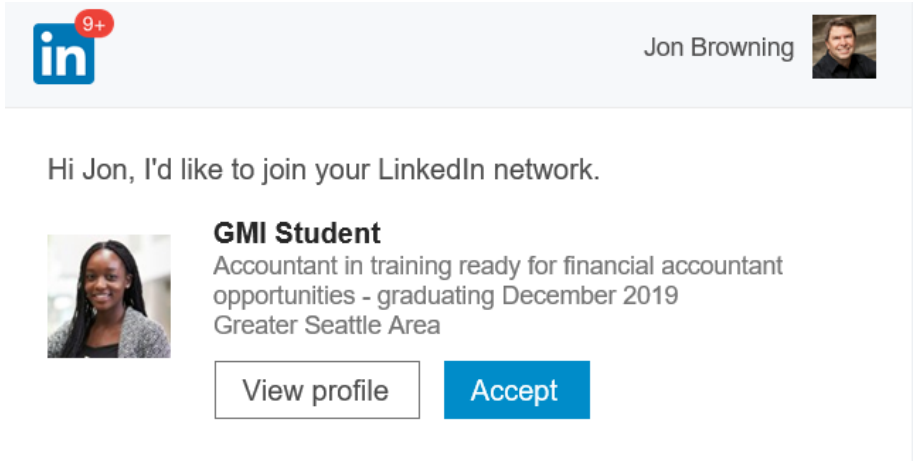
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Always Make it Personal

This?

Which invitation is more likely to be accepted?

Or this?

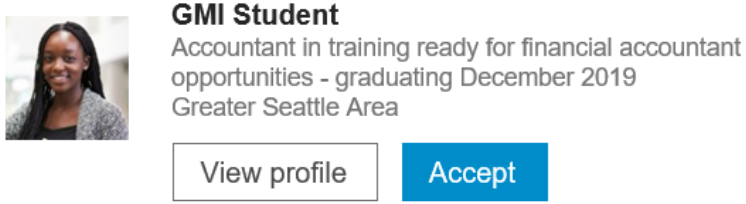


Hi Jon,

We both know William Smith at Accenture and I see they are connected to you on LinkedIn. I am a Business Management student at ABC University graduating soon and would appreciate connecting with you on LinkedIn.

Best regards,

GMI Student
Graduating May 2022



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10 Templates for Making Connections

Use these templates as guides to connect with people on LinkedIn.

Personalize them and copy and paste to quickly make a lot of business connections.

These are important for your job search.

- Someone currently attending the same school as you
- Someone is connected to another person you know
- Someone who went to your college in the past
- Someone who works at a company where you want to apply
- Someone who made a comment in a LinkedIn group
- Someone you have no connection with
- Someone you met or heard speak at a conference
- Someone who viewed your LinkedIn profile
- Someone who has posted a job opportunity – before applying
- Someone who has posted a job opportunity – after applying



You are limited to 200 characters in your connection request. Make the most of it!

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How to Connect with People

1

Someone currently attending the same school as you:
Hi [First Name],
We are both students at [College/University] and I would like to connect with you on LinkedIn.

2

Someone is connected on LinkedIn to another person you know:
Hi [First Name],
We both know (First & Last Name at (Company) and I see you are connected on LinkedIn. I would like to join your LinkedIn network.

3

Someone who went to your college in the past:
Hi [First Name],
I see that you are an alumnus from [College/University], and I look forward to being one next year too, as I am a [Your Major] student in my [#] year. I hope you will consider connecting with me on LinkedIn.

4

Someone who works at a company where you want to apply:
Hi [First Name],
We haven't met but your profile came up when I was looking for open positions at [Company Name]. I hope you will consider connecting with me on LinkedIn.

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How to Connect with People

5

Someone who made a comment in a LinkedIn group:

Hi [First Name],
I am a fellow member of the [Group Name] LinkedIn group. I hope you will consider connecting with me on LinkedIn.

6

Someone you have no connection with:

Hi [First Name],
I am a [Your Major] student graduating from [College/University] this year and would appreciate the opportunity to join your LinkedIn network.

7

Someone you met or heard speak at a conference:

Hi [First Name],
It was a pleasure to hear you speak at [Event/Conference]. Your topic was personally very helpful to me in my job search. I would like to join your LinkedIn network.

8

Someone who viewed your LinkedIn profile:

Hi [First Name],
Thank you for visiting my profile. I am very interested to connect with you to learn more about your career path and the work you do at [Company Name].

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How to Connect with People

9

Someone who has posted a job opportunity – before applying:

Hi [First Name],

I noticed the position you posted earlier and have hands-on experience in [skill]. I would appreciate connecting with you to discuss the position.

10

Someone who has posted a job opportunity – after applying:

Hi [First Name],

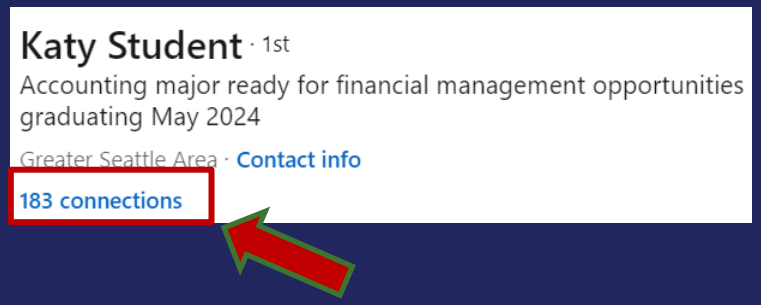
I wanted to let you know that I applied online for the position of [Position Title (#Job ID)]. I would appreciate connecting with you to discuss how I could potentially add value to your team.

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Finding Targeted Connections at Companies

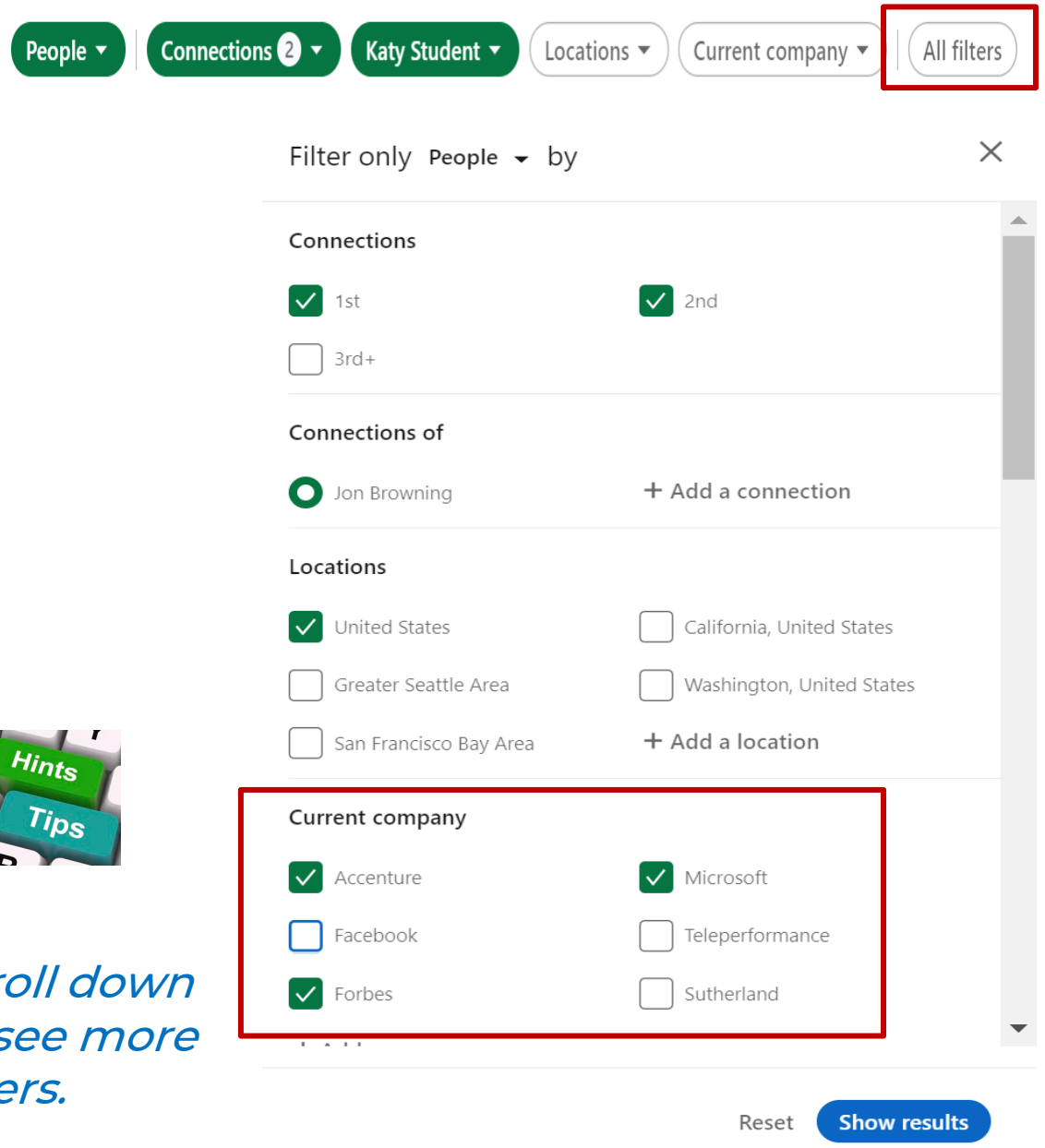
After connecting with someone, you can see 1st and 2nd level connections that you have in common.

Filter on the companies you are interested in and invite these people to connect with you.



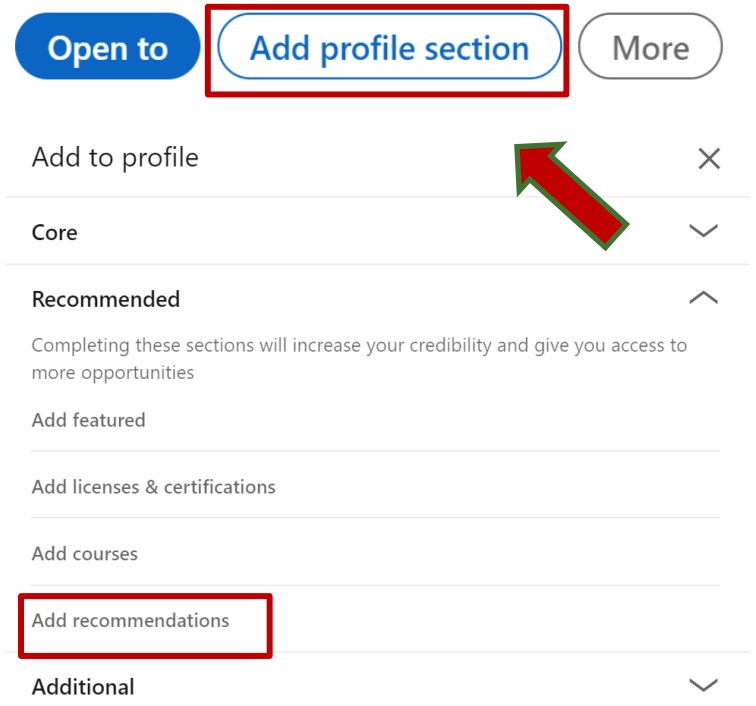


Scroll down to see more filters.



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Getting Professional Recommendations



Request written recommendations of your professional experiences, accomplishments, and skills from previous supervisors, colleagues, and other professional connections who know you well enough to make a recommendation.

- ✓ Submit a request via LinkedIn for your professional connections to write short reviews of your work/skills.
- ✓ Request recommendations from colleagues who can highlight your key skills and accomplishments.

- ✓ Recommendations add credibility to the work and skills listed on your resume/CV. Link these references on your resume.
- ✓ LinkedIn asks you to approve recommendations before adding them to your profile.

- ✓ Obtain at least five recommendations from your connections. Recruiters read them!

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How to ask for a Recommendation

Personalized Message

Hi Jason, I hope all is well for you.

Would you be willing to provide a recommendation for me on LinkedIn? Since I might be looking at new career options soon, a personal note from you on my LinkedIn page would be very helpful.

To save you some time, below is an example that you could use but I am very glad if you want to use different text. If you are unable to do this now, I completely understand.

Thank you!
Michael Smith

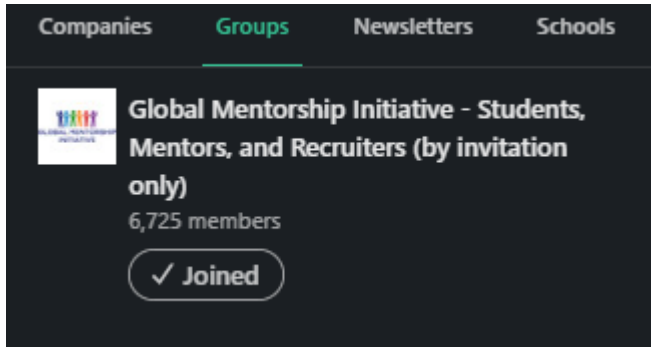
Personalize a recommendation like the examples below.
Choose only one to include in your request.

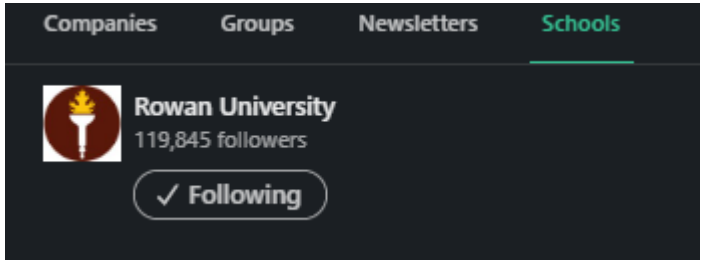
Style Option 1:
I have known Michael for many years and have always been impressed by his commitment and drive both in his career and personal life. His dedication to social responsibility is demonstrated by his volunteerism with [Company]. His encouragement to students in the program is an inspiration and sets an example for others.

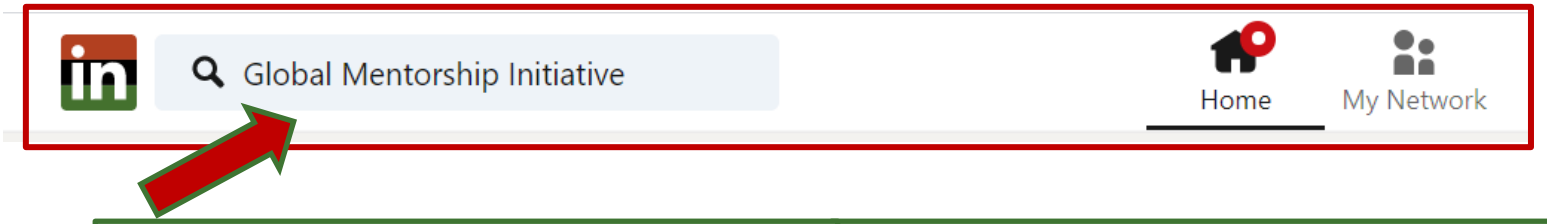
Style Option 2:
I was fortunate to work alongside Michael at [Company] and we worked closely on several projects. Michael was always very focused on supporting the mission and achieving his objectives. He was a very effective computer science assistant and was able to teach complex computer skills to students of all ages in a way they could understand and retain the knowledge.

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Professional Pages and Groups







Follow Pages

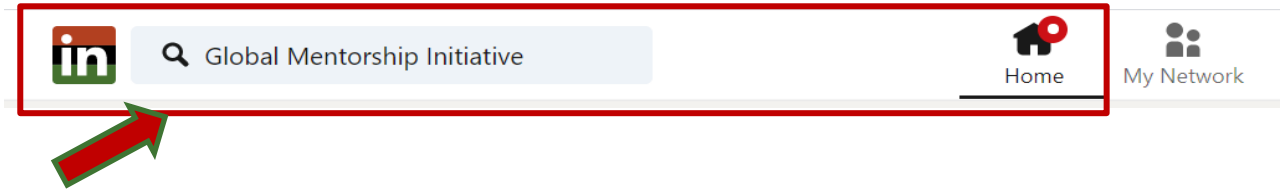
- ✓ Companies you want to work for (Engaged with company talent brand)
- ✓ Prospective future career paths or occupations
- ✓ Something you want to learn more about

Join Groups

- ✓ Companies you want to work for (Engaged with company talent brand)
- ✓ With people who do work that interests you
- ✓ For a cause you are passionate about

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Follow these Pages Now



Company – Click on Follow

Global Mentorship Initiative

Or:
https://www.linkedin.com/company/globalmentorship

Your college alumni group

Search for this on LinkedIn

After you join these groups, connect with people in them using the right templates.

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LinkedIn Job Search

LinkedIn's Job Board

Activate LinkedIn Open Candidates on your profile to let recruiters know you are open to new career opportunities.

LinkedIn Job Filters

Job searching on LinkedIn allows you to filter for specific position titles, companies, industries, etc.

Job Alerts

Receive an email every time a new job is posted that meets your specific search criteria.

Easy Apply

Allows you to apply using your LinkedIn profile and upload a resume.

Your LinkedIn profile is what recruiters will see first.

Get the most from LinkedIn to find jobs that match your skillset.

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Let Recruiters Know You are Available

- ✓ *Click on View Profile*
- ✓ *Set your career interests to alert recruiters*
- ✓ *Decide who should see that you are available*

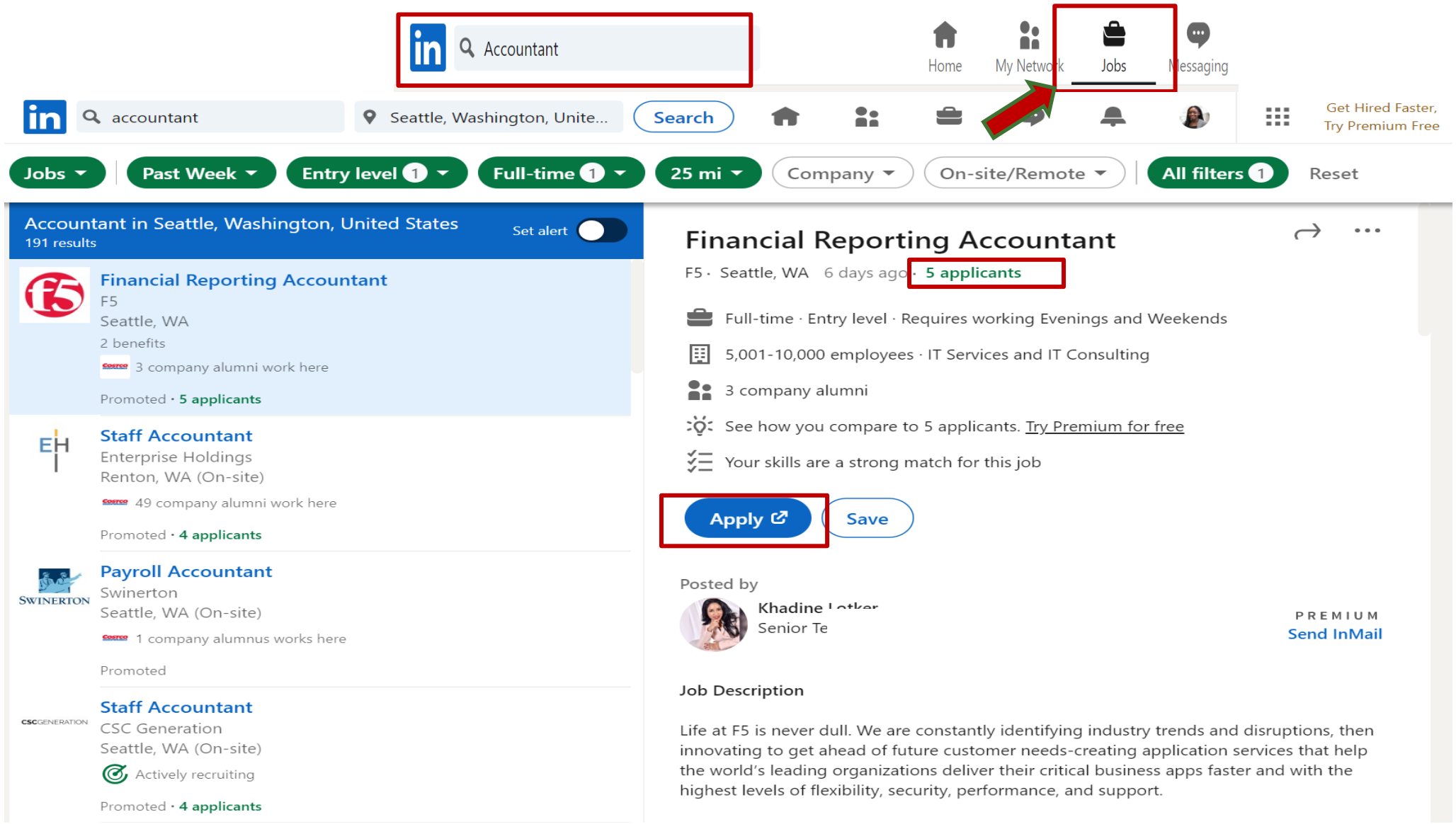


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Search for Jobs

Search Jobs: Accountant
Search Location: Seattle

- ✓ *Apply online*
- ✓ *See how many people have applied*
- ✓ *See if you know anyone at the company*

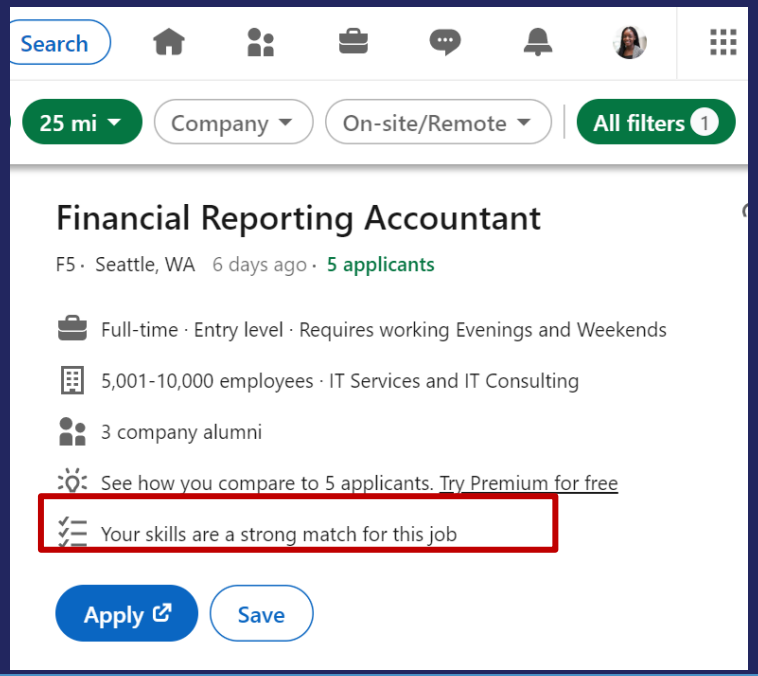


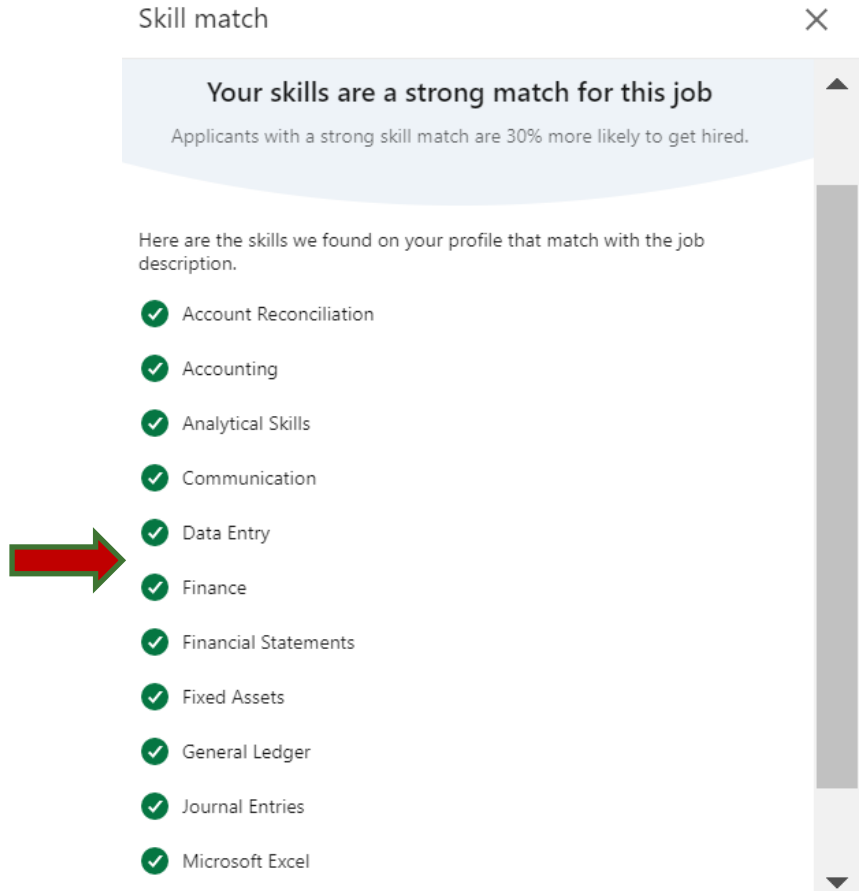
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What are my chances for this job?

Only for LinkedIn Premium Members

- ✓ *See who's viewed your profile*
- ✓ *Job and applicant insights*
- ✓ *Company insights*
- ✓ *Salary insights*



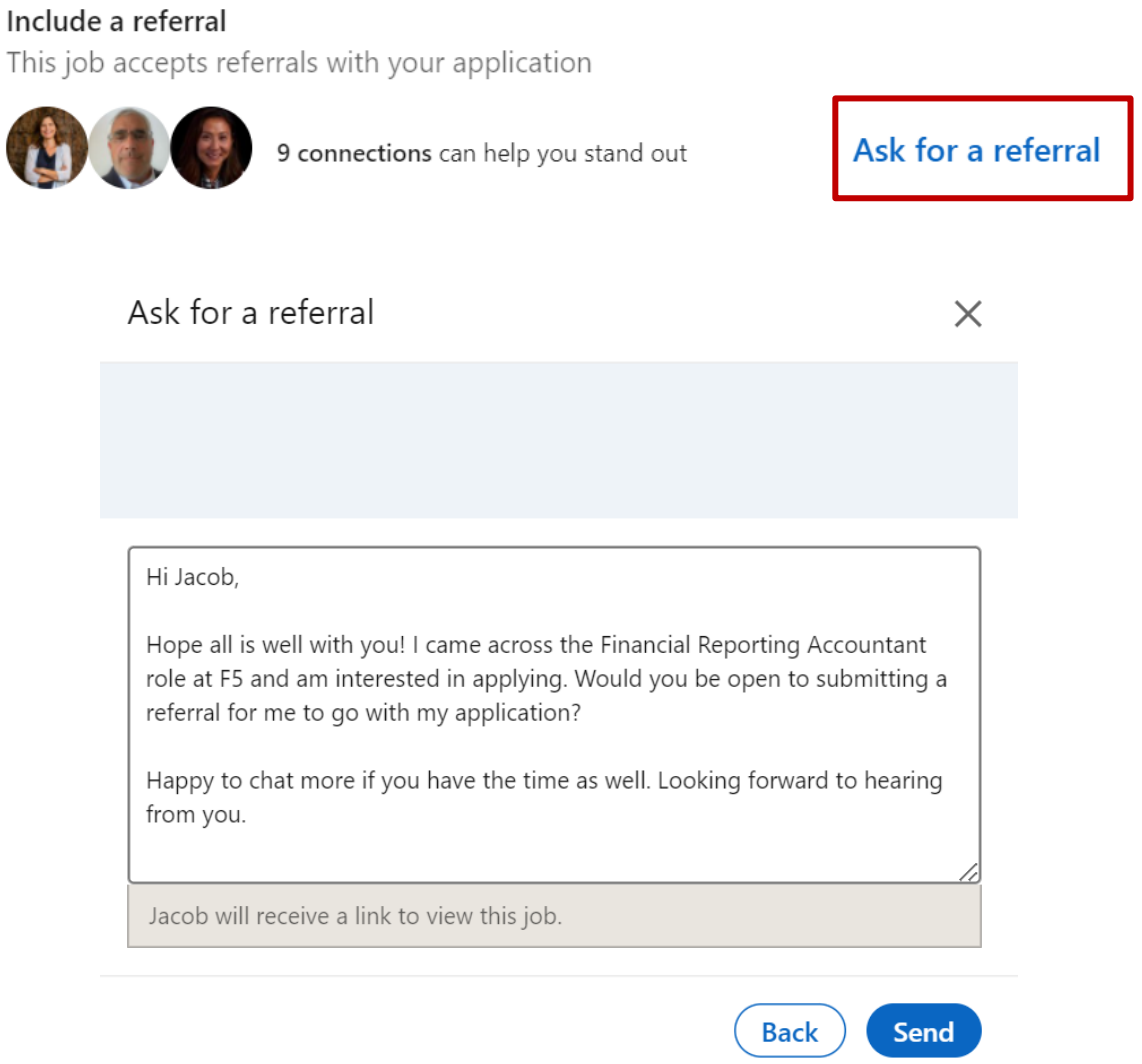


Matching skills are important to get an interview.

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How to Get Referrals through LinkedIn

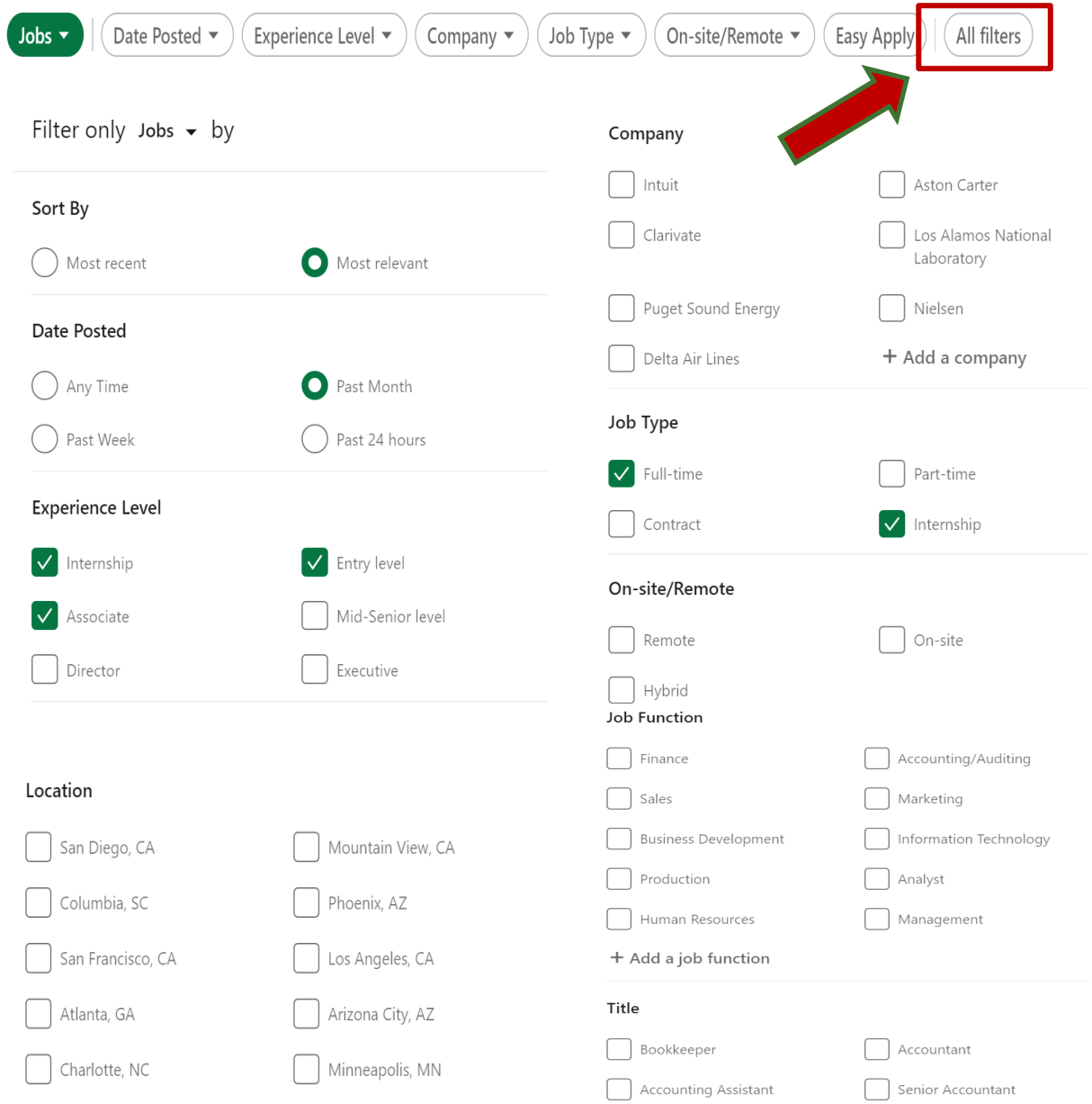
Not all companies who post jobs on LinkedIn will accept referrals using this method. This option will not show up for all jobs posted.



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Refine Your Search with Filters

- ✓ *Apply for jobs just posted*
- ✓ *Match your skill level to the job*
- ✓ *Target a specific company or industry*



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Market Yourself with a Banner



Identifies you as someone who goes beyond just meeting the requirements.



Banner Recommendations

- ✓ Banners add a personal aspect to your profile
- ✓ Be creative but remember this is a business environment
- ✓ Examples: your city or your business interests
- ✓ Pictures must have the correct dimensions
- ✓ “Crop” pictures to get the right shape
- ✓ Left side is for your headshot

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Further Discussion

Questions to Ask Your Mentor

- ✓ How often do you engage on LinkedIn?
- ✓ Do you create post on LinkedIn? If so, what do you post about?
- ✓ What do you wish you had done earlier on LinkedIn?
- ✓ What feedback do you have on my LinkedIn account?
- ✓ Have you ever had recruiters reach out to you on LinkedIn?

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Action Items Before Next Session

Before Session 4

- ✓ Request recommendations on LinkedIn profile from at least five professional colleagues
- ✓ Use the techniques discussed during the training to request connections with professionals on LinkedIn to work toward your goal of connecting with 500 business professionals by the end of the mentorship program
- ✓ Continue working to complete professional LinkedIn profile.
- ✓ Mark Session 3 as complete on the Student Portal

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Additional Resources and References

‘10 LinkedIn Profile Summaries We Love (And How to Boost Your Own’ – Kate Reilly with LinkedIn Talent Blog
https://business.linkedin.com/talent-solutions/blog/linkedin-best-practices/2016/7-linkedin-profile-summaries-that-we-love-and-how-to-boost-your-own

‘7 Vital Components of Your LinkedIn Experience Section, With Examples’ – Jodie Cook with Forbes
https://www.forbes.com/sites/jodiecook/2025/05/02/7-vital-components-of-your-linkedin-experience-section-with-examples/

‘How to Build an Exceptional LinkedIn Profile: Top Tips for Students’ – Toni Critelli with St. Johns University
https://www.stjohns.edu/news-media/johnnies-blog/build-exceptional-linkedin-profile-top-student-tips

‘The Ultimate Guide to Building Your First LinkedIn Profile: Best Practices for College Students’ – Marsh Sutherland with Sacred Heart University
https://shuconnect.sacredheart.edu/blog/2025/04/23/the-ultimate-guide-to-building-your-first-linkedin-profile-best-practices-for-college-students/

‘LinkedIn Invitation Request Examples’ – Michigan Tech University
https://www.mtu.edu/career/students/networking/linkedin/linkedin-invitation-examples-march-2016.pdf

‘7 Ways To Include Keywords In Your LinkedIn Profile
https://cheekyscientist.com/ways-to-include-keywords-in-your-linkedin-profile

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